

CONCEPT NOTE

TAFIYA

A Trusted Digital Accommodation Marketplace for Northern Nigeria

Tagline: *Your Journey. Your Stay.*

1. Background

Northern Nigeria is home to a growing network of hotels, guest houses, serviced apartments, lodges and other accommodation providers serving business travellers, students, tourists, families, professionals, government officials, development organisations and people travelling for religious, social and cultural activities.

Despite the growing demand for accommodation, discovering and booking reliable accommodation in many cities across Northern Nigeria can still be difficult. Travellers often depend on personal recommendations, social media, phone calls or informal agents to identify available accommodation.

This creates challenges around **availability, pricing, location, trust, transparency and convenience**.

At the same time, many accommodation providers, particularly small and medium-sized hotels, do not have access to sophisticated digital booking and property-management systems.

Tafiya is proposed as a digital platform designed to bridge this gap.

2. The Problem

Travellers looking for accommodation in Northern Nigeria may face several challenges:

- Difficulty discovering available and suitable hotels.
- Limited reliable information about properties.
- Outdated or inaccurate hotel information online.
- Difficulty comparing prices and amenities.
- Uncertainty about whether accommodation providers are legitimate.
- Booking processes that depend heavily on phone calls or physical visits.
- Limited digital booking infrastructure among smaller hotels.
- Difficulty managing reservations for hotels that still rely on manual processes.

For accommodation providers, challenges include:

- Limited online visibility.
- Dependence on walk-in customers and referrals.
- Manual booking management.
- Difficulty reaching new customers.
- Limited access to booking analytics.
- Difficulty managing room availability across different channels.

3. Proposed Solution

Tafiya will provide a centralized digital marketplace where travellers can discover, compare and book verified accommodation across Northern Nigeria.

The platform will connect:

Travellers ↔ Hotels & Accommodation Providers

Users will be able to search for accommodation by **city, location, price, dates, room type, amenities and purpose of travel**.

Accommodation providers will have access to a dedicated dashboard where they can manage their property, rooms, prices, availability and bookings.

The platform will also introduce a **property verification system** to improve trust and transparency.

4. Vision

To become the most trusted digital accommodation and travel marketplace connecting people with quality stays across Northern Nigeria.

5. Mission

To make accommodation discovery and booking **simple, accessible, transparent and trustworthy** while helping local accommodation businesses grow through digital technology.

6. Objectives

The project aims to:

1. Digitize accommodation discovery and booking across Northern Nigeria.
2. Increase the online visibility of local accommodation providers.
3. Make it easier for travellers to compare accommodation options.
4. Improve transparency around prices, facilities and availability.
5. Build trust through property verification.
6. Provide accommodation businesses with digital tools for managing bookings.

7. Create opportunities for small and medium-sized hotels to participate in the digital economy.
8. Generate reliable data and insights about accommodation demand and supply.

7. Target Users

A. Travellers

Including:

- Business travellers
- Tourists
- Families
- Students and parents
- Government officials
- NGO and development workers
- Researchers
- Event attendees
- Long-stay guests
- People travelling for weddings and social events

B. Accommodation Providers

- Hotels
- Guest houses
- Lodges
- Serviced apartments
- Short-let apartments
- Boutique accommodation
- Resorts

C. Platform Administrators

Responsible for:

- Verification
- Customer support
- Content moderation
- Booking management
- Dispute resolution
- Payments
- Platform analytics

8. Initial Geographic Focus

The platform will initially focus on major cities and commercial centres in Northern Nigeria, with potential early deployment in states such as:

- Bauchi
- Kaduna
- Kano
- Gombe
- Plateau
- Adamawa
- Yobe
- Borno
- Sokoto
- Katsina
- Jigawa
- Kebbi
- Zamfara
- Niger

The rollout can begin with a smaller number of cities before expanding across the region.

9. Core Features

9.1 Accommodation Discovery

Users can search for properties based on:

- City
- Location
- Check-in/check-out dates
- Number of guests
- Price
- Property type
- Amenities
- Rating
- Availability

9.2 Hotel Profiles

Each property will have a dedicated profile containing:

- Hotel name
- Description
- Location
- Photos

- Room types
- Prices
- Amenities
- Available services
- Check-in/check-out information
- Cancellation policy
- Contact information
- Reviews
- Verification status

9.3 Verified Properties

Tafiya will introduce a verification system to help users identify legitimate properties.

Potential verification levels could include:

Property Submitted

↓

Documents Verified

↓

Location Verified

↓

Property Verified

Verified properties may receive a visible **Verified Property badge**.

9.4 Booking

Users will be able to:

1. Select a property.
2. Select a room.
3. Select dates.
4. Enter guest information.
5. Review booking details.
6. Make payment or select available payment options.
7. Receive confirmation.

Each booking will generate a unique booking reference.

10. Hotel Management Dashboard

Accommodation providers will be able to:

- Create their property profile.
- Upload photos.
- Add rooms.
- Set prices.
- Update room availability.
- Manage reservations.
- View upcoming bookings.
- Manage guest information.
- View earnings.
- Create promotions.
- Respond to reviews.
- Update property information.

This will help smaller accommodation businesses move from largely manual processes toward digital management.

11. Revenue Model

Tafiya can operate using a marketplace commission model.

For example:

Guest books ₦50,000 room

↓

Tafiya charges an agreed percentage commission.

↓

Hotel receives the remaining amount according to the platform's settlement terms.

Additional revenue streams could eventually include:

- Featured property listings
- Promotional campaigns
- Hotel subscription plans
- Premium analytics
- Corporate booking services
- Advertising
- Travel partnerships
- Property-management tools

The exact commission structure should be determined after testing the market and understanding hotel economics.

12. Competitive Advantage

Tafiya's differentiation would be its **Northern Nigeria-first approach**.

Rather than simply replicating a global hotel marketplace, the platform can be designed around local needs, including:

- Local accommodation providers
- Local payment preferences
- Local travel patterns
- Local languages and communication
- Regional customer support
- Property verification
- Smaller hotels and guest houses
- City-level accommodation discovery
- Local business onboarding

13. MVP

The first version of Tafiya should remain focused.

Guest App

- Registration/login
- Search
- Filters
- Hotel listings
- Hotel profile
- Room information
- Booking
- Payment
- Booking confirmation
- Booking history
- Reviews

Hotel Dashboard

- Registration
- Verification
- Property profile
- Room management
- Price management

- Availability
- Booking management
- Earnings

Admin Dashboard

- User management
- Hotel verification
- Property management
- Booking management
- Payment monitoring
- Reviews
- Complaints
- Analytics

14. Future Expansion

Once the accommodation marketplace is established, Tafiya could expand beyond hotels into a broader **travel and hospitality ecosystem**.

Potential future services include:

Tafiya Stays — Hotels and accommodation

Tafiya Apartments — Short-lets and serviced apartments

This creates the possibility of developing Tafiya into a broader Northern Nigerian travel platform.

15. Expected Impact

Tafiya is expected to contribute to:

For travellers

- Easier accommodation discovery
- Greater transparency
- Improved booking convenience
- Increased confidence through verification

For hotels

- Increased visibility
- More customers
- Digital booking infrastructure
- Better reservation management

- Access to customer insights

For the wider economy

- Digital transformation of hospitality businesses
- Increased technology adoption among SMEs
- Job and entrepreneurship opportunities
- Growth of domestic tourism
- Improved digital participation in Northern Nigeria

16. Conclusion

Tafiya seeks to address a practical gap in Northern Nigeria's hospitality and digital economy by creating a trusted platform connecting travellers with accommodation providers.

By combining **technology, verification, digital payments, local market understanding and simple booking tools**, the platform can help make accommodation discovery more convenient for travellers while providing local hospitality businesses with the digital infrastructure they need to reach more customers.

The initial focus will be accommodation, with a long-term opportunity to develop Tafiya into a broader **Northern Nigeria travel and hospitality ecosystem**.

TAFIYA

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